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Independent, data-driven assessment by BNN Asia. Every figure is drawn from the BNN Asia database and cited to its source record. Event-data statistics describe reported patterns and do not establish causes.

Executive Summary

Bangladesh is not ranked in the 2026 BNN Asia Index – insufficient data: the verified data currently available does not meet the coverage threshold. Data coverage is 38% of the index weight.

This report highlights 3 key findings derived from the largest statistical deviations and trends.

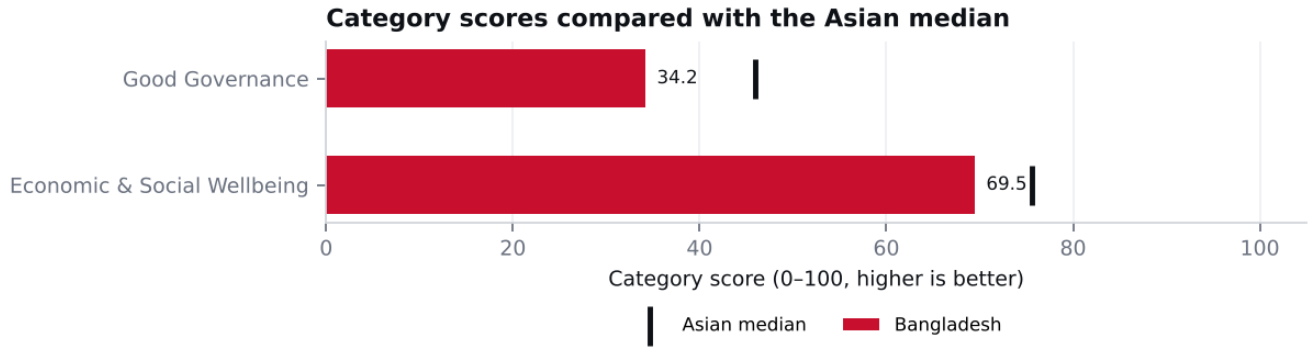


Figure: Category scores compared with the Asian median. Source: BNN Asia database.

Key Findings

- The rate of state repression of civilians and civil society (4.89 per 1,000 in-country events) is 3.1× the Asian median of 1.56 (z-score +1.6 across 48 countries). [1]
- The rate of arrests and detentions by state actors (15.54 per 1,000 in-country events) is 2.3× the Asian median of 6.70 (z-score +1.2 across 48 countries). [2]
- Repression of protest/opposition changed by +54% between the first and the second half of the observed period (0.55 → 0.85 per 1,000 in-country events). [3]

1. GDELT 2.0 Event Database – BNN Asia daily aggregation – signal: State repression of civilians and civil society (2026-01-01 – 2026-11-06) – https://www.gdeltproject.org/data.html
2. GDELT 2.0 Event Database – BNN Asia daily aggregation – signal: Arrests and detentions by state actors (2026-01-01 – 2026-11-06) – https://www.gdeltproject.org/data.html
3. GDELT 2.0 Event Database – BNN Asia daily aggregation – signal: Repression of protest/opposition (2026-01-01 – 2026-11-06) – https://www.gdeltproject.org/data.html

Country Overview

Bangladesh (South Asia). Capital: Dhaka.

This report draws on 23 verified indicator values, 0 published verified incidents and 63 days of processed GDELT event data for the 2026 reporting period (1 January 2026 – 31 December 2026).

Good Governance

Bangladesh scores 34.2/100 in Good Governance, rank 36 of 47 ranked Asian countries. The Asian median for this category is 46.0, so the score is 11.8 points below the median.

Indicators with verified data: Government Effectiveness (WGI) [1, 2, 3]; Regulatory Quality (WGI) [4, 5, 6]; Control of Corruption (WGI) [7, 8, 9].

6 of these values are historical references for comparison and do not count towards scores.

INDICATOR	VALUE	REFERENCE	STATUS	CI	SOURCE
Government Effectiveness (WGI)	-0.44 est.	GOV_WGI_GE.EST 2025	Final	–	World Bank [1]
Government Effectiveness (WGI) HISTORICAL	-0.57 est.	GOV_WGI_GE.EST 2024	Final	–	World Bank [2]
Government Effectiveness (WGI) HISTORICAL	-0.45 est.	GOV_WGI_GE.EST 2023	Final	–	World Bank [3]
Regulatory Quality (WGI)	-0.94 est.	GOV_WGI_RQ.EST 2025	Final	–	World Bank [4]
Regulatory Quality (WGI) HISTORICAL	-0.96 est.	GOV_WGI_RQ.EST 2024	Final	–	World Bank [5]
Regulatory Quality (WGI) HISTORICAL	-0.91 est.	GOV_WGI_RQ.EST 2023	Final	–	World Bank [6]
Control of Corruption (WGI)	-0.98 est.	GOV_WGI_CC.EST 2025	Final	–	World Bank [7]
Control of Corruption (WGI) HISTORICAL	-1.10 est.	GOV_WGI_CC.EST 2024	Final	–	World Bank [8]
Control of Corruption (WGI) HISTORICAL	-1.20 est.	GOV_WGI_CC.EST 2023	Final	–	World Bank [9]

1. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #5666]
2. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #5667]
3. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #5668]
4. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #5807]
5. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #5808]
6. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #5809]
7. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #5948]
8. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #5949]
9. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #5950]

Human Rights

No Human Rights score: the verified data for Bangladesh does not meet the category coverage threshold.

No verified indicator data for this period.

Press Freedom

No Press Freedom score: the verified data for Bangladesh does not meet the category coverage threshold.

No verified indicator data for this period.

Rule of Law

No Rule of Law score: the verified data for Bangladesh does not meet the category coverage threshold.

Indicators with verified data: Rule of Law (WGI) [1, 2, 3].

2 of these values are historical references for comparison and do not count towards scores.

INDICATOR	VALUE	REFERENCE	STATUS	CI	SOURCE
Rule of Law (WGI)	-0.91 est.	GOV_WGI_RL.EST 2025	Final	–	World Bank [1]
Rule of Law (WGI) HISTORICAL	-0.95 est.	GOV_WGI_RL.EST 2024	Final	–	World Bank [2]
Rule of Law (WGI) HISTORICAL	-0.90 est.	GOV_WGI_RL.EST 2023	Final	–	World Bank [3]

1. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #6089]
2. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #6090]
3. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #6091]

Economic & Social Wellbeing

Bangladesh scores 69.5/100 in Economic & Social Wellbeing, rank 33 of 43 ranked Asian countries. The Asian median for this category is 75.6, so the score is 6.1 points below the median.

Indicators with verified data: Real GDP growth [1, 2]; Inflation (CPI, annual) [3, 4]; GDP per capita (current US$) [5, 6, 7]; Human Development Index [8]; Population (denominator only) [9, 10, 11].

7 of these values are historical references for comparison and do not count towards scores.

4 of 11 values are preliminary or estimated and may be revised by the source.

INDICATOR	VALUE	REFERENCE	STATUS	CI	SOURCE
Real GDP growth	3.60 %	WEO NGDP_RPCH 2026	Estimated	–	International Monetary Fund [1]
Real GDP growth HISTORICAL	3.50 %	WEO NGDP_RPCH 2025	Preliminary	–	International Monetary Fund [2]
Inflation (CPI, annual)	8.70 %	WEO PCPIPCH 2026	Estimated	–	International Monetary Fund [3]
Inflation (CPI, annual) HISTORICAL	10.00 %	WEO PCPIPCH 2025	Preliminary	–	International Monetary Fund [4]
GDP per capita (current US$)	2,597 US$	NY.GDP.PCAP.CD 2025	Final	–	World Bank [5]
GDP per capita (current US$) HISTORICAL	2,593 US$	NY.GDP.PCAP.CD 2024	Final	–	World Bank [6]
GDP per capita (current US$) HISTORICAL	2,551 US$	NY.GDP.PCAP.CD 2023	Final	–	World Bank [7]
Human Development Index HISTORICAL	0.69 0–1	HDI 2023	Final	–	UNDP [8]
Population (denominator only)	175,686,899 people	SP.POP.TOTL 2025	Final	–	World Bank [9]

INDICATOR	VALUE	REFERENCE	STATUS	CI	SOURCE
Population (denominator only) HISTORICAL	173,562,364 people	SP.POP.TOTL 2024	Final	–	World Bank [10]
Population (denominator only) HISTORICAL	171,466,990 people	SP.POP.TOTL 2023	Final	–	World Bank [11]

1. IMF – World Economic Outlook (DataMapper) – https://www.imf.org/external/datamapper/NGDP_RPCH@WEO/BGD [obs. #199]
2. IMF – World Economic Outlook (DataMapper) – https://www.imf.org/external/datamapper/NGDP_RPCH@WEO/BGD [obs. #198]
3. IMF – World Economic Outlook (DataMapper) – https://www.imf.org/external/datamapper/PCPIPCH@WEO/BGD [obs. #2318]
4. IMF – World Economic Outlook (DataMapper) – https://www.imf.org/external/datamapper/PCPIPCH@WEO/BGD [obs. #2317]
5. World Bank – World Development Indicators – https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/NY.GDP.PCAP.CD?locations=BD [obs. #5511]
6. World Bank – World Development Indicators – https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/NY.GDP.PCAP.CD?locations=BD [obs. #5512]
7. World Bank – World Development Indicators – https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/NY.GDP.PCAP.CD?locations=BD [obs. #5513]
8. UNDP – Human Development Report – https://hdr.undp.org/data-center/human-development-index [obs. #5318]
9. World Bank – World Development Indicators – https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SP.POP.TOTL?locations=BD [obs. #5372]
10. World Bank – World Development Indicators – https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SP.POP.TOTL?locations=BD [obs. #5373]
11. World Bank – World Development Indicators – https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SP.POP.TOTL?locations=BD [obs. #5374]

Event Data Analysis

Between 1 January 2026 and 6 November 2026, GDELT recorded 35,194 events located in Bangladesh. Signal counts below are expressed per 1,000 of these in-country events and compared with the median rate across 48 Asian countries with event data.

Coercion or violence against media/journalists: 112 events, 3.18 per 1,000 in-country events (Asian median 1.89, 1.7× the median). Highest monthly activity: January 2026 (36 events). [1]

Arrests/detentions of media workers: 19 events, 0.54 per 1,000 in-country events (Asian median 0.40, 1.3× the median). Highest monthly activity: March 2026 (6 events). [1]

State repression of civilians and civil society: 172 events, 4.89 per 1,000 in-country events (Asian median 1.56, 3.1× the median). Highest monthly activity: February 2026 (30 events). [1]

Arrests and detentions by state actors: 547 events, 15.54 per 1,000 in-country events (Asian median 6.70, 2.3× the median). Highest monthly activity: January 2026 (93 events). Latest complete month vs previous (October 2026 vs September 2026): -41% in the rate. [1]

Killings and physical assaults (all actors): 2,714 events, 77.12 per 1,000 in-country events (Asian median 53.83, 1.4× the median). Highest monthly activity: January 2026 (721 events). Latest complete month vs previous (October 2026 vs September 2026): +64% in the rate. [1]

Protest events: 429 events, 12.19 per 1,000 in-country events (Asian median 6.32, 1.9× the median). Highest monthly activity: February 2026 (117 events). Latest complete month vs previous (October 2026 vs September 2026): +41% in the rate. [1]

Repression of protest/opposition: 24 events, 0.68 per 1,000 in-country events (Asian median 0.13, 5.2× the median). Highest monthly activity: February 2026 (8 events). [1]

Bans, restrictions and censorship: 100 events, 2.84 per 1,000 in-country events (Asian median 1.65, 1.7× the median). Highest monthly activity: February 2026 (22 events). [1]

Judicial and legal cooperation events: 344 events, 9.77 per 1,000 in-country events (Asian median 9.81, 1.0× the median). Highest monthly activity: February 2026 (59 events). Latest complete month vs previous (October 2026 vs September 2026): -24% in the rate. [1]

Example source articles for the most active days (evidence trail, not verified by BNN Asia): [2] [3] [4] [5] [6].

SIGNAL	EVENTS	RATE / 1,000	ASIAN MEDIAN	RATIO	Z	2ND VS 1ST HALF
Coercion or violence against media/ journalists	112	3.18	1.89	1.7×	+0.5	-25%
Arrests/detentions of media workers	19	0.54	0.40	1.3×	-0.1	+79%
State repression of civilians and civil society	172	4.89	1.56	3.1×	+1.6	-9%
Arrests and detentions by state actors	547	15.54	6.70	2.3×	+1.2	+8%
Killings and physical assaults (all actors)	2,714	77.12	53.83	1.4×	0.0	-20%
Protest events	429	12.19	6.32	1.9×	+0.8	-9%
Repression of protest/opposition	24	0.68	0.13	5.2×	+0.8	+54%
Bans, restrictions and censorship	100	2.84	1.65	1.7×	+0.5	-24%
Judicial and legal cooperation events	344	9.77	9.81	1.0×	-0.1	+13%

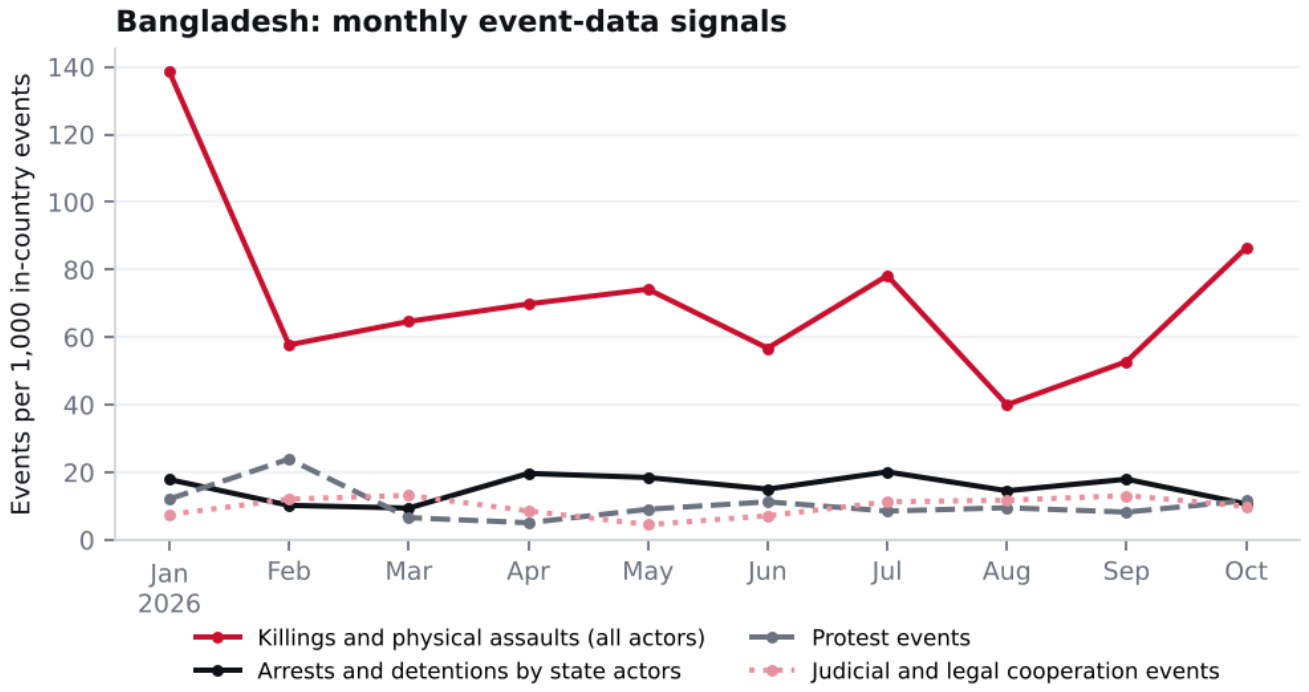


Figure: Monthly trend of the main event-data signals. Source: BNN Asia database.

1. GDELT 2.0 Event Database – BNN Asia daily aggregation (2026-01-01 – 2026-11-06) – https://www.gdeltproject.org/data.html
2. Source article (Repression of protest/opposition, 2026-02-06) – https://www.jagonews24.com/en/politics/news/89661
3. Source article (State repression of civilians and civil society, 2026-02-06) – https://www.dhakatribune.com/bangladesh/dhaka/402665/road-in-front-of-hotel-intercontinental-turns-into
4. Source article (Arrests and detentions by state actors, 2026-01-11) – https://www.tbsnews.net/bangladesh/migration/bangladeshis-lured-nepal-tortured-and-extorted-europe-trafficking-route-1331121
5. Source article (Protest events, 2026-02-06) – https://www.thedailystar.net/news/bangladesh/crime-justice/news/killing-osman-hadi-govt-decides-propose-un-probe-4099441
6. Source article (Coercion or violence against media/journalists, 2026-01-06) – https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/world/south-asia/bangladesh-unrest-2-hindu-men-murdered-as-violence-surges-6-such-killings-in-18-days/articleshow/126363926.cms

Major Verified Incidents

No verified incidents recorded for this period.

Appendix A · Methodology and Limitations

BNN Asia Index methodology v1.0.0 (aggregation mode: Auto reweight).

Weighted composite of six categories. Indicators are min–max normalised to 0–100 on their theoretical scale (or the observed Asian range for counts); lower-is-better indicators are inverted. Category scores are weighted means of available indicators. Missing categories are imputed with the lower of the country's own mean and the Asian median, so missing data can never raise a score.

Limitations. Counts of verified incidents reflect BNN monitoring capacity, which differs by country. International indices describe the previous calendar year. Rankings are BNN Asia's own calculation and are not rankings of the source organisations.

Event-data statistics. Signal counts are GDELT events located in the country and matched to the public BNN Asia signal taxonomy (CAMEO codes and actor types). Counts are expressed per 1,000 of all GDELT events located in the same country, which adjusts for differences in overall media attention. The Asian median is the median of that rate across all active countries with event data. A z-score is the distance from the cross-country mean in standard deviations and is only reported when at least 5 countries have data. Trends compare the rate in the first and second half of the observed days, and the latest month with the preceding one. Deviations and trends are only highlighted as findings when the country has at least 10 matching events.

Limitations of event data. Event data reflect what the news media report, not everything that happens: coverage differs between countries, languages and outlets, and attention spikes around major news. Events are coded by machine from news text, so individual records can be misclassified, duplicated or wrongly located. In restrictive media environments incidents are under-reported, so a low rate can indicate limited reporting rather than few incidents. Event-data figures are therefore indicators of reported activity and describe patterns only; they do not establish causes or responsibility and are not used as verified incident counts.

Report generation. This report is generated automatically from the BNN Asia database and may afterwards be edited by BNN Asia editors. Each regeneration creates a new version; earlier versions are kept.

Appendix B · Sources and References

1. GDELT 2.0 Event Database – BNN Asia daily aggregation – signal: State repression of civilians and civil society (2026-01-01 – 2026-11-06) – https://www.gdeltproject.org/data.html
2. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #5666]
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4. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #5668]
5. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #5807]
6. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #5808]
7. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #5809]
8. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #5948]
9. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #5949]
10. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #5950]
11. World Bank – Worldwide Governance Indicators – https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators [obs. #6089]

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14. IMF – World Economic Outlook (DataMapper) – https://www.imf.org/external/datamapper/NGDP_RPCH@WEO/BGD [obs. #199]
15. IMF – World Economic Outlook (DataMapper) – https://www.imf.org/external/datamapper/NGDP_RPCH@WEO/BGD [obs. #198]
16. IMF – World Economic Outlook (DataMapper) – https://www.imf.org/external/datamapper/PCPIPCH@WEO/BGD [obs. #2318]
17. IMF – World Economic Outlook (DataMapper) – https://www.imf.org/external/datamapper/PCPIPCH@WEO/BGD [obs. #2317]
18. World Bank – World Development Indicators – https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/NY.GDP.PCAP.CD?locations=BD [obs. #5511]
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22. World Bank – World Development Indicators – https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SP.POP.TOTL?locations=BD [obs. #5372]
23. World Bank – World Development Indicators – https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SP.POP.TOTL?locations=BD [obs. #5373]
24. World Bank – World Development Indicators – https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SP.POP.TOTL?locations=BD [obs. #5374]
25. Source article (Repression of protest/opposition, 2026-02-06) – https://www.jagonews24.com/en/politics/news/89661
26. Source article (State repression of civilians and civil society, 2026-02-06) – https://www.dhakatribune.com/bangladesh/dhaka/402665/road-in-front-of-hotel-intercontinental-turns-into
27. Source article (Arrests and detentions by state actors, 2026-01-11) – https://www.tbsnews.net/bangladesh/migration/bangladeshis-lured-nepal-tortured-and-extorted-europe-trafficking-route-1331121
28. Source article (Protest events, 2026-02-06) – https://www.thedailystar.net/news/bangladesh/crime-justice/news/killing-osman-hadi-govt-decides-propose-un-probe-4099441
29. Source article (Coercion or violence against media/journalists, 2026-01-06) – https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/world/south-asia/bangladesh-unrest-2-hindu-men-murdered-as-violence-surges-6-such-killings-in-18-days/articleshow/126363926.cms

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